

Japan Banks: Refocusing on new midterm plan ROE targets, potential P/B upside

Given increasing interest in bank stocks on the back of BOJ rate hike outlook, we would like to refocus on the banks' midterm plans. This earnings season, many banks updated their midterm plans, which are a key point of interest for investors. The FY3/29 plans of major and mid-tier banks are targeting 3-year net profit CAGRs of c.8-25%, indicating a continuation of high profit growth. This is despite many banks only assuming approximately 0.75-1.25% policy rate or 0-2 additional hikes in their plans.

Midterm plan profit growth is supported not only by the tailwind of expanding loan-deposit spreads from rising domestic interest rates, but also by a broad-based demand for financial functions. This demand is driven by factors including robust domestic funding needs, buoyant capital markets, an acceleration of corporate actions like corporate restructuring and business succession, the proliferation of cashless payments, and the provision of asset management products amid the secular shift "from savings to investment".

Low-to-mid 10% handle ROE levels in sight

ROE targets in the medium-term plans are a key point of interest for overseas investors. A common theme across the updated medium-term plans from many banks is sustainable profit growth, driven by policy rate hikes and business expansion, and consequently higher ROE targets. Whereas previous medium-term plan ROE targets were often in the 10-12% range for megabanks and 6-8% for major regional banks, the May disclosures included targets of over 12% for megabanks, and we also saw several major regional banks targeting over 10% ROE based on TSE standards.

In addition, there have been more disclosures of medium- to long-term ROE targets extending beyond the medium-term plan period, with megabanks setting ROE levels with global top-tier banks in mind. MUFG expects to achieve its current medium-term plan ROE target of 12% this fiscal year, and appears to be positioning itself to aim for mid-teens ROE in the medium to long term, taking into account the ROE levels of US bank competitors and the interest rate differential between their home markets. SMFG drew attention from market participants in March when it announced a medium- to long-term ROE target of 15%, and its May disclosure materials outlined a structure for achieving 15% ROE by shifting its business portfolio to high-growth-potential areas such as investment banking, S&T, and its multi-franchise strategy. Mizuho raised its medium-term ROE target from over 10%

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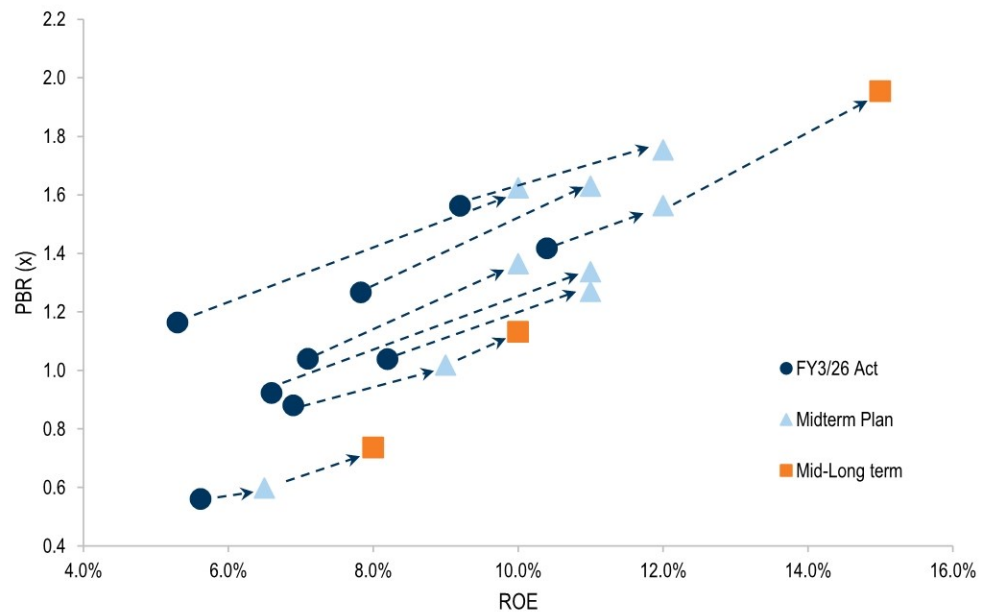
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in FY3/28 to over 12% in FY3/29, and also clearly stated its intention to aim for a P/B on par with global peers by leveraging the strengths of its sound and stable business portfolio to improve ROE and PER (“Beyond PBR 2.0x”).

Among the major regional banks, Resona HD has set a medium-term plan ROE target of 12% assuming a 1.0% policy rate, and also showed ROE target 14% assuming a 1.5% policy rate, which makes theirs one of the higher ROE targets. Given their ROE image of 14% is within the midterm plan period, this surpasses some of the major banks’ targets, and reflects high rate sensitivity and advantage in deposit base. In addition, Shizuoka FG has also indicated a mid-teens ROE target for FY2030.

Japan Post Bank showed in its new midterm plan that they expect ROE to rise sharply from FY3/26 5.3% to FY3/29 10%. The recurring profit is expected to rise +Y800bn from yen rate asset drivers, mainly JGB portfolio reconstruction, and +Y200bn from risk asset drivers such as PE and foreign bond investment trust. The rise in short- and long-term rates are a tailwind here, as well as the impression of fine performance in the PE portion.

ROE is both a profitability indicator and a metric that influences the formation of bank share prices. As P/B multiples can be broken down into ROE and cost of equity, bank stocks with higher ROE tend to trade at higher P/B multiples, which explains the high level of investor interest in ROE. The chart below shows the ROE targets in the medium-term plans and the long-term ROE targets for major and mid-tier banks that disclosed new medium-term plans or updated KPIs for existing plans this earnings season, as well as the P/B levels calculated by multiplying each ROE target by the current P/E ratio. Currently, banks with FY3/26 ROE of 6–10% are trading at P/B multiples of 0.6–1.5x. However, if ROE rises toward the medium-term and medium- to long-term targets along the same P/B-ROE slope, it suggests that higher P/B multiples could be unlocked, assuming other conditions such as the external environment remain unchanged. Going forward, we intend to track the progress of each bank’s strategy toward its disclosed ROE targets.

Exhibit 1: Image of P/B-ROE for MTP & Mid-Long term target ROE

ROE: KPIs of respective banks, PBR based on closing price of 1st June 2026, / Note that Policy rate assumptions differ for each bank / PBR except FY3/26 is calculated by PER of June 1st and Company disclosed ROE

Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Major banks' midterm plan ROE targets

	MTP ROE target	Policy rate assumption	Main drivers
MUFG	FY27/3 12%	1.00%	Next MTP currently being formulated. Current MTP drivers are corporate business, US/Asia, markets
SMFG	FY29/3 12%	1.25%	Deposit revenue at Olive/Trunk, corporate business, transaction banking, Asia investment profit
Mizuho	FY29/3 12%	0.75%	Corporate business, global CIB growth, WM/AM growth
Resona	FY29/3 12%	1.00%	Loan demand growth, digital payments platform
SMTG	FY29/3 11%	1.25%	Asset management business, private assets, product loan, digital bank
JPB	FY29/3 10%	Forward rate	JGB portfolio growth, foreign bond/PE investment profit

Source: Company data

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